

GORE DRAFT · THE OFFICIAL MANUAL

RTFM
BETA 0.2.1

READ THIS FUCKING MANUAL

Everything you need to write a horror script, break down every gag, and get it to set. Short chapters, lots of pictures, no padding.

IDEAS / SCRIPTS / **FX BREAKDOWNS** / REAL FILMS

SPLATTERVHS.COM

00 WHAT'S IN HERE

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PRO TIP Short on time? Read chapters **03** and **06**. That's the whole point of GORE DRAFT: write the scene, then tag the blood.

01 INSTALL IT

TWO MINUTES, ONE SCARY WARNING

WINDOWS

1. Download `GoreDraft-Setup-0.2.0-beta.exe`.
2. Double-click it. Windows will probably say **"Windows protected your PC"**.
3. Click **More info → Run anyway**. The beta isn't code-signed yet, and that's the only reason Windows complains.
4. Choose **Install for me only** if you don't have admin rights. It works exactly the same.
5. Launch it from the Start Menu or the desktop shortcut.



The **BETA** stamp means you're early. Thanks for that.

LINUX & CHROMEBOOK

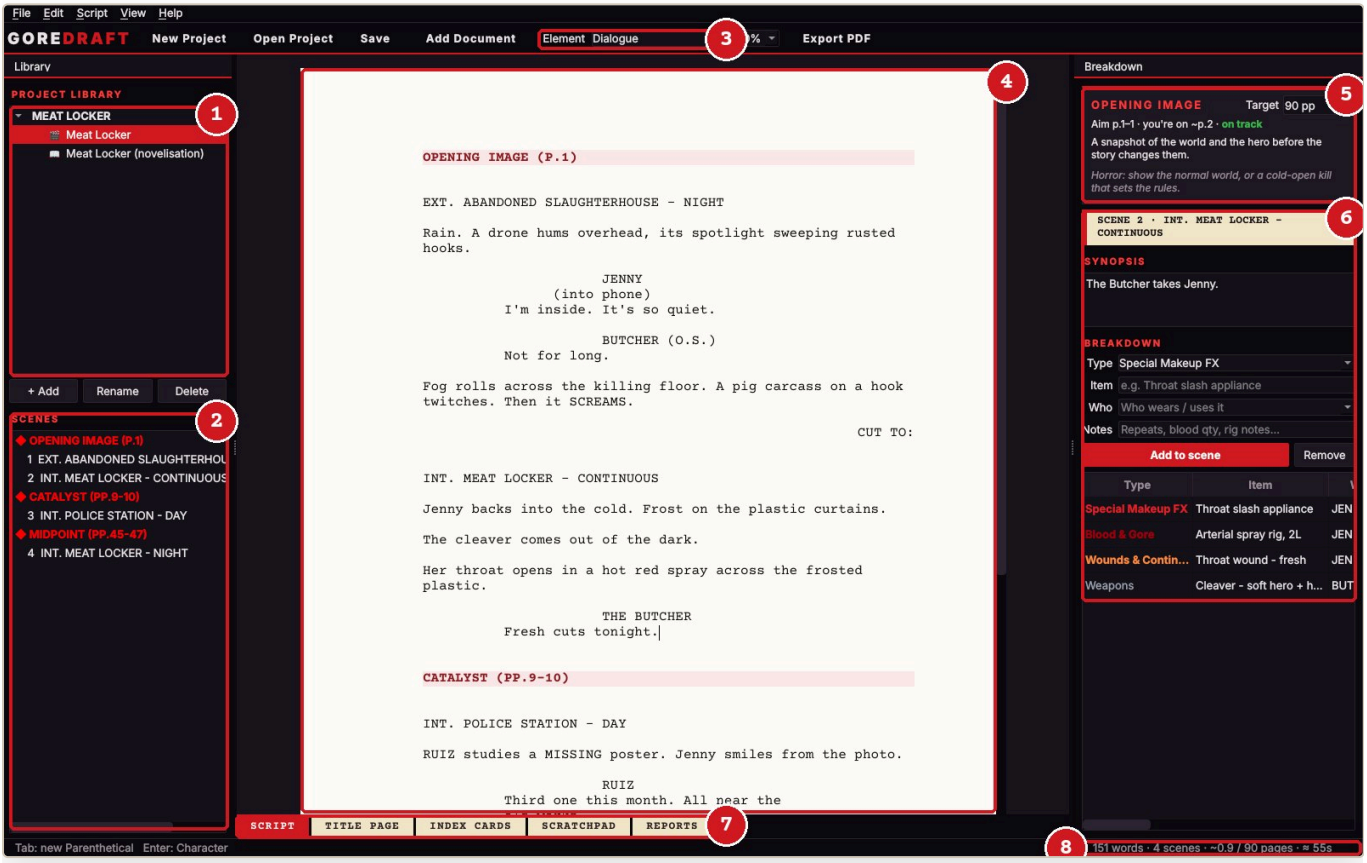
1. Download `GoreDraft-0.2.0-linux-x86_64.tar.gz` and unpack it.
2. Run `GoreDraft/GoreDraft`.
3. Optional: run `GoreDraft/install.sh` to add it to your apps menu.

Chromebooks: turn on Linux first (*Settings → Advanced → Developers → Linux development environment*). It needs an Intel or AMD processor, not ARM.

HEADS UP No account. No sign-in. No internet needed, ever. If the app asks you to log in to anything, it isn't GORE DRAFT.

02 THE TOUR

EIGHT THINGS ON ONE SCREEN



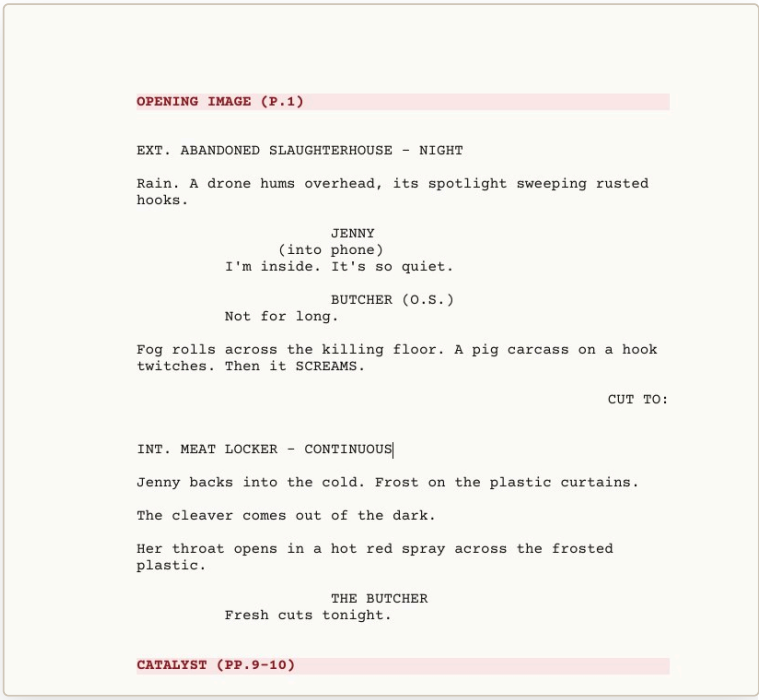
1. **Project library.** Every script and novel in this project. **+ Add** makes a new one, and double-clicking renames it.
2. **Scenes.** Click to jump there. **Drag** to reorder. Red ◆ lines are beats.
3. **Element.** What the current line is: heading, action, dialogue and so on. Change it here or with `Ctrl` + `1` – `8`.
4. **The page.** A real screenplay page with real margins, so a page here is roughly a minute on screen.
5. **Beat guide.** Which Save the Cat beat you're in, and whether you're on time.
6. **Breakdown.** The effects, props and cast for the scene your cursor is in.
7. **Tabs.** Script, Title Page, Index Cards, Scratchpad and Reports.
8. **Status bar.** Words, scenes, pages and estimated **runtime**. Bottom-left tells you what Tab and Enter will do next.

> **PRO TIP** Panels in the way? **View** menu → untick Library or Breakdown, or press `F11` for Zen mode and lose everything but the page (chapter 12).

03 YOUR FIRST SCENE

THE TAB & ENTER DANCE

You never touch formatting. Two keys do it all: `Enter` starts the **next** line, and `Tab` changes **what kind** of line it is.



```
OPENING IMAGE (P.1)

EXT. ABANDONED SLAUGHTERHOUSE - NIGHT

Rain. A drone hums overhead, its spotlight sweeping rusted
hooks.

                    JENNY
              (into phone)
        I'm inside. It's so quiet.

                    BUTCHER (O.S.)
        Not for long.

Fog rolls across the killing floor. A pig carcass on a hook
twitches. Then it SCREAMS.

                                                    CUT TO:

INT. MEAT LOCKER - CONTINUOUS

Jenny backs into the cold. Frost on the plastic curtains.

The cleaver comes out of the dark.

Her throat opens in a hot red spray across the frosted
plastic.

                    THE BUTCHER
        Fresh cuts tonight.

CATALYST (PP.9-10)
```

All of this was typed with Tab and Enter. No formatting by hand.

WRITE A SCENE IN 5 MOVES

1. Type `int. meat locker - night.` As soon as you type `INT.` it turns into a **Scene Heading**.
2. `Enter` gives you **Action**. Describe the horror.
3. `Tab` gives you a **Character**. Type their name.
4. `Enter` gives you **Dialogue**. Make them talk.
5. `Enter` gives you the next **Character**. Hit `Enter` again on the empty line to drop back to **Action**.

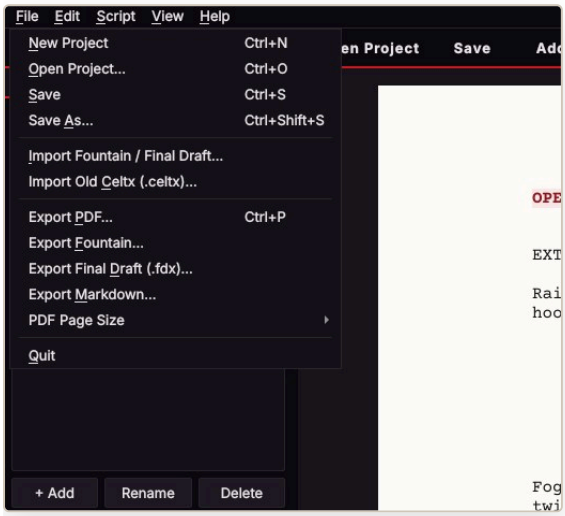
SCENE HEADING	ACTION	CHARACTER	DIALOGUE	CHARACTER
Enter ↓	Tab ↓	Enter ↓	Enter ↓	Enter = Action

THE OTHER MOVES

- **Parenthetical:** `Tab` straight after typing a character name gives you `( )`. `Tab` again jumps to the dialogue.
- **Transition:** type `CUT TO:` on an action line and it slides to the right by itself.
- **Wrong element?** On an empty line, keep pressing `Tab` to cycle through them, or press `Ctrl` +number. Bottom-left of the screen always says what `Tab` and `Enter` will do next.

04 BRING YOUR OLD SCRIPTS

RESCUE THE DRAWER



Everything comes in and goes out through the **File** menu.

GORE DRAFT was born because we had dozens of horror scripts stuck in old Celtx desktop files. Yours can come with you too.

OLD CELTX (.CELTX)

1. **File → New Project**, then **File → Import Old Celtx**.
2. Pick your `.celtx` file.
3. Every script, novel and scratchpad comes in with its original names and order. Cast from your old catalog is tagged on the scenes too.
4. **Save.** That's the moment your old work turns into plain files you own forever.

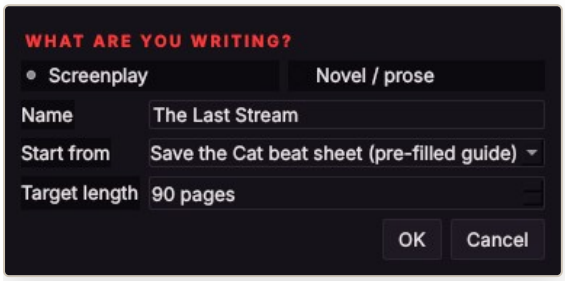
FINAL DRAFT & FOUNTAIN

File → Import Fountain / Final Draft takes `.fdx`, `.fountain` and plain-text Fountain files.

HEADS UP Celtx sketches, storyboards and calendars contain no text, so they're skipped. Your words, scenes and scratchpads all come through.

05 THE BEAT GUIDE

SAVE THE CAT, WITH BLOOD ON IT



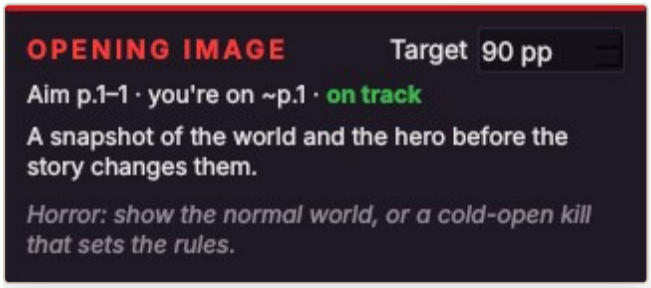
+ Add → Screenplay → **Save the Cat beat sheet**. Set your target length.

Start a script from the beat sheet, or use **Script → Insert Save the Cat Beats** on one you've already started. You get **15 red markers**, each with its target page for your length, and an empty line ready under each.

The markers are a **guide only**. They never print, and they never end up in your PDF or Final Draft file.

JUMP BETWEEN BEATS

`Ctrl` + `]` for the next beat, `Ctrl` + `[` for the previous one.



The beat guide follows your cursor.

READING THE GUIDE

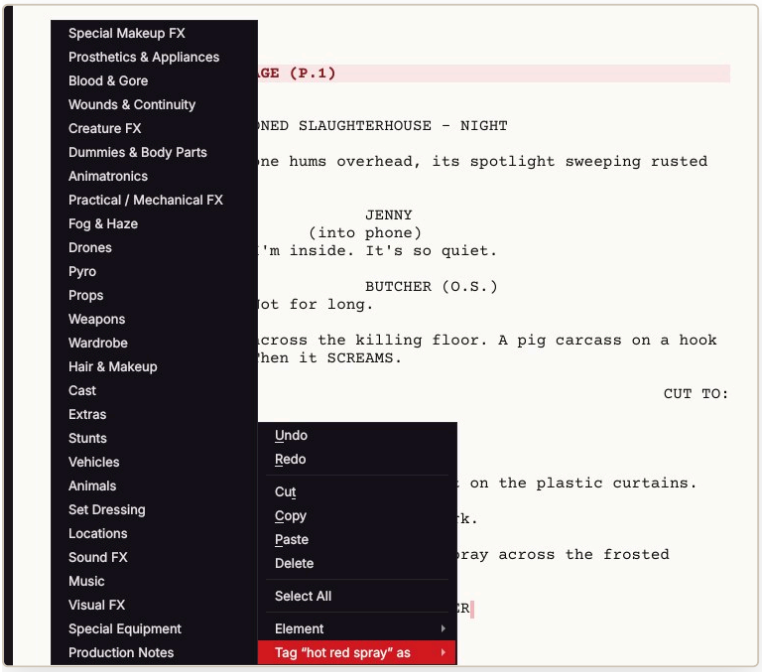
- **Aim:** where this beat should land.
- **You're on:** your actual page.
- **on track** · **early** · **running long**
- The grey italic line is the **horror version** of the beat: what it usually looks like in a horror film.

> **PRO TIP** "Running long" is a nudge, not a rule. FX set pieces eat pages, and that's fine. Change your target length in the beat guide if you're making a 60-pager.

06 BREAK DOWN THE GORE

THE REASON THIS APP EXISTS

Every scene gets a breakdown: every effect, prop, weapon and actor it needs. Put the cursor **anywhere in a scene** and the right-hand panel shows that scene.



Select the words, **right-click → Tag as**, and pick the type. Done.

FASTEST WAY: TAG FROM THE PAGE

1. Select some words in the script, like *hot red spray*.
2. **Right-click → Tag "..." as** and choose a category.

FULL WAY: THE PANEL

1. Pick a **Type**.
2. Type the **Item**: *Throat slash appliance*.
3. Pick **Who** wears or uses it. **This matters** for the continuity report.
4. Add **Notes**: repeats, blood quantity, rig details.
5. **Add to scene**, or just press `Enter`.

Click any cell in the list to edit it. **Remove** deletes the selected row.

EFFECTS COME FIRST

`Special Makeup FX` `Prosthetics & Appliances` `Blood & Gore` `Wounds & Continuity`
`Creature FX` `Dummies & Body Parts` `Animatronics` `Practical / Mechanical FX` `Fog & Haze`
`Drones` `Pyro`

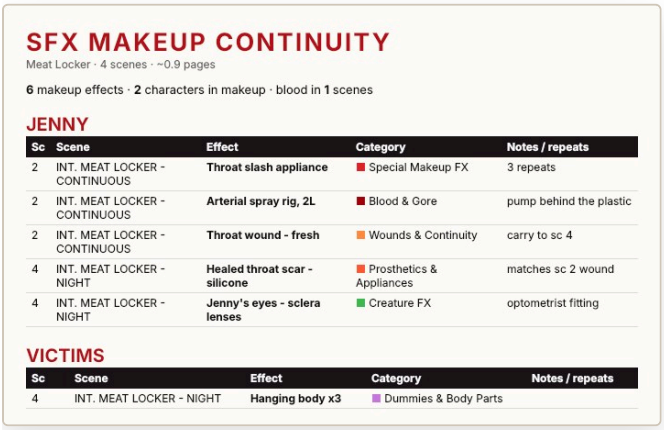
Below those come the usual production categories: props, weapons, wardrobe, hair & makeup, cast, extras, stunts, vehicles, animals, set dressing, locations, sound FX, music, visual FX, special equipment and production notes.

> **PRO TIP** Always fill in **Who** for makeup. "Throat wound, JENNY, carry to sc 4" is what lets the continuity report track her wound across the whole film, so you know how many appliances to run before day one. The scene's **synopsis** box also shows on its index card.

07 REPORTS

PAPERWORK FOR THE WORKSHOP

Open the **Reports** tab and pick one from the list. Every report can be exported as a **PDF** or **HTML** to print, email or pin to the workshop wall.



SFX MAKEUP CONTINUITY

Meat Locker · 4 scenes · ~0.9 pages

6 makeup effects · **2** characters in makeup · blood in **1** scenes

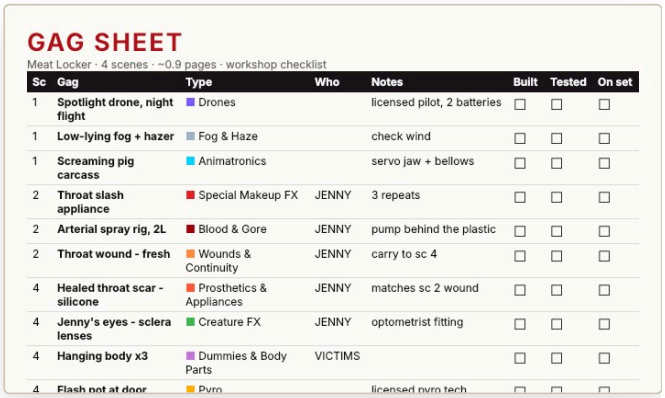
JENNY

Sc	Scene	Effect	Category	Notes / repeats
2	INT. MEAT LOCKER - CONTINUOUS	**Throat slash appliance**	Special Makeup FX	3 repeats
2	INT. MEAT LOCKER - CONTINUOUS	**Arterial spray rig, 2L**	Blood & Gore	pump behind the plastic
2	INT. MEAT LOCKER - CONTINUOUS	**Throat wound - fresh**	Wounds & Continuity	carry to sc 4
4	INT. MEAT LOCKER - NIGHT	**Healed throat scar - silicone**	Prosthetics & Appliances	matches sc 2 wound
4	INT. MEAT LOCKER - NIGHT	**Jenny's eyes - sclera lenses**	Creature FX	optometrist fitting

VICTIMS

Sc	Scene	Effect	Category	Notes / repeats
4	INT. MEAT LOCKER - NIGHT	**Hanging body x3**	Dummies & Body Parts	

SFX Makeup Continuity. Every makeup effect, grouped by character, in scene order.

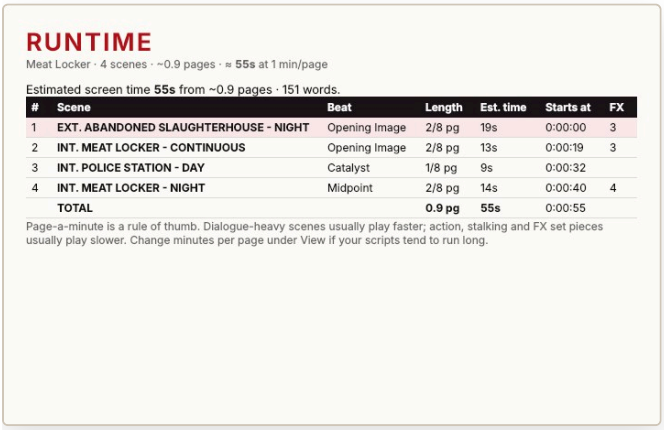


GAG SHEET

Meat Locker · 4 scenes · ~0.9 pages · workshop checklist

Sc	Gag	Type	Who	Notes	Built	Tested	On set
1	**Spotlight drone, night flight**	Drones		licensed pilot, 2 batteries	☐	☐	☐
1	**Low-lying fog + hazer**	Fog & Haze		check wind	☐	☐	☐
1	**Screaming pig carcass**	Animatronics		servo jaw + bellows	☐	☐	☐
2	**Throat slash appliance**	Special Makeup FX	JENNY	3 repeats	☐	☐	☐
2	**Arterial spray rig, 2L**	Blood & Gore	JENNY	pump behind the plastic	☐	☐	☐
2	**Throat wound - fresh**	Wounds & Continuity	JENNY	carry to sc 4	☐	☐	☐
4	**Healed throat scar - silicone**	Prosthetics & Appliances	JENNY	matches sc 2 wound	☐	☐	☐
4	**Jenny's eyes - sclera lenses**	Creature FX	JENNY	optometrist fitting	☐	☐	☐
4	**Hanging body x3**	Dummies & Body Parts	VICTIMS		☐	☐	☐
4	**Flash pot at door**	Pyro		licensed pyro tech	☐	☐	☐

Gag Sheet. Every practical gag with Built, Tested and On set boxes. Print it and tick it off.



RUNTIME

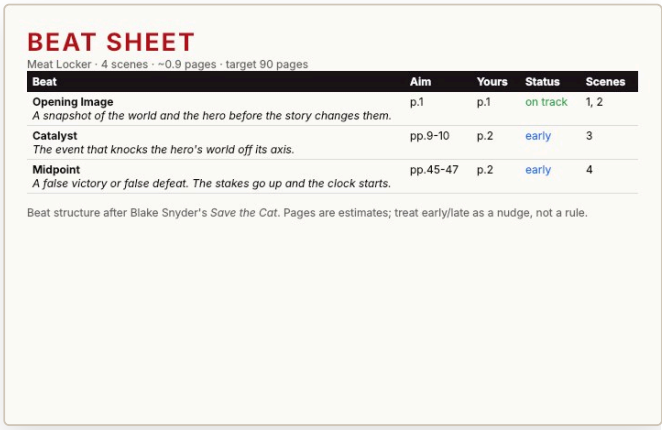
Meat Locker · 4 scenes · ~0.9 pages · ≈ **55s** at 1 min/page

Estimated screen time **55s** from ~0.9 pages · 151 words.

#	Scene	Beat	Length	Est. time	Starts at	FX
1	**EXT. ABANDONED SLAUGHTERHOUSE - NIGHT**	Opening Image	2/8 pg	19s	0:00:00	3
2	**INT. MEAT LOCKER - CONTINUOUS**	Opening Image	2/8 pg	13s	0:00:19	3
3	**INT. POLICE STATION - DAY**	Catalyst	1/8 pg	9s	0:00:32	
4	**INT. MEAT LOCKER - NIGHT**	Midpoint	2/8 pg	14s	0:00:40	4
	TOTAL		**0.9 pg**	**55s**	0:00:55	

Page-a-minute is a rule of thumb. Dialogue-heavy scenes usually play faster; action, stalking and FX set pieces usually play slower. Change minutes per page under View if your scripts tend to run long.

Runtime. Each scene's length, time and start timecode. Effects scripts play long? Set **View → Minutes per Page** to 1.2.



BEAT SHEET

Meat Locker · 4 scenes · ~0.9 pages · target 90 pages

Beat	Aim	Yours	Status	Scenes
Opening Image *A snapshot of the world and the hero before the story changes them.*	p.1	p.1	on track	1, 2
Catalyst *The event that knocks the hero's world off its axis.*	pp.9-10	p.2	early	3
Midpoint *A false victory or false defeat. The stakes go up and the clock starts.*	pp.45-47	p.2	early	4

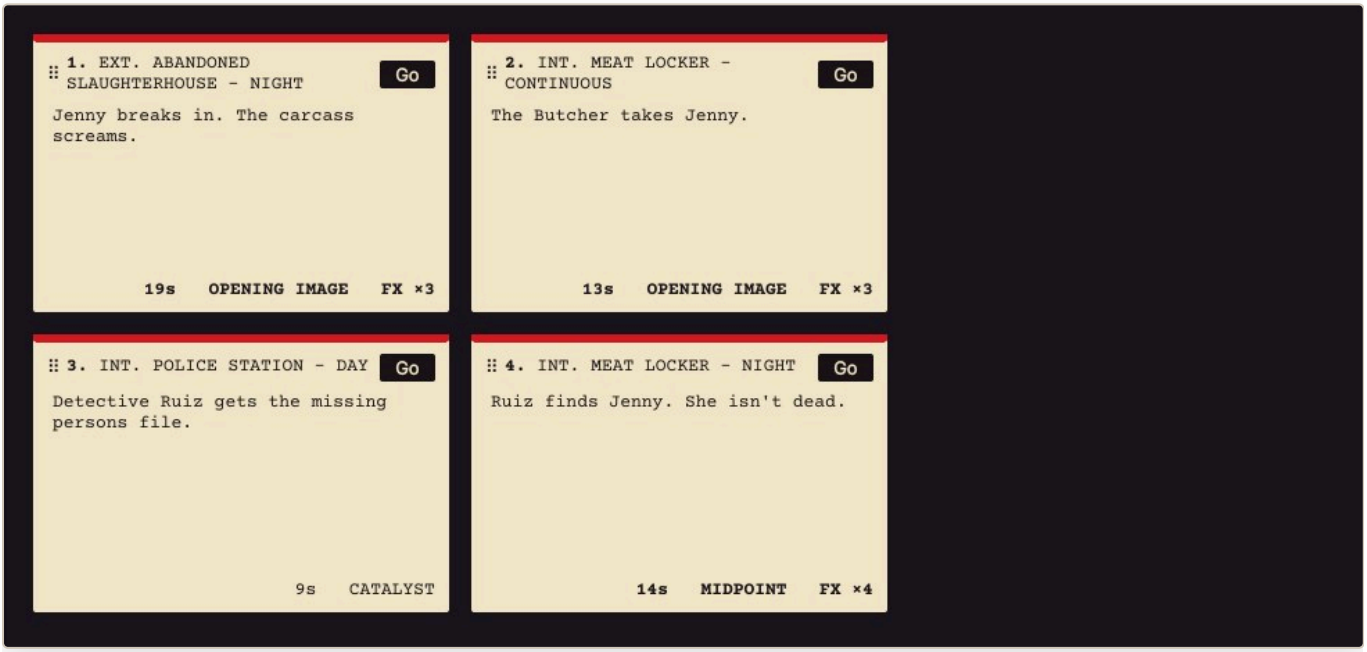
Beat structure after Blake Snyder's *Save the Cat*. Pages are estimates; treat early/late as a nudge, not a rule.

Beat Sheet. Your structure against your actual pages.

REPORT	USE IT FOR
Scene Breakdown (with or without description)	The 1st AD's favourite: every scene with its cast and all tagged items.
Elements	Shopping lists: all props, all weapons, all wardrobe and so on, each with the scenes they're in.
Dialogue	Every line per character, for casting and table reads. Filter by character.
Cast & Scenes	Which scenes each actor is in, to plan shoot days.

08 CARDS & RESHUFFLING

MOVE THE BODIES AROUND



Each card shows the scene's synopsis, its length, its beat and how many **FX** it needs.

REORDER SCENES: THREE WAYS

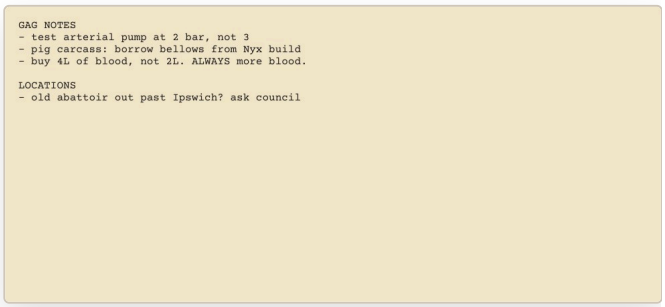
- **Index Cards:** drag a card by its header (the ⠿ grip) onto another card. Drop it on the **left half** to go before, or the **right half** to go after.
- **Scenes list:** drag a scene up or down.
- **Keyboard:** `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `↑` / `↓` moves the scene your cursor is in.

The scene's text, synopsis and whole breakdown move together. Changed your mind? `Ctrl` + `Z`.

TITLE PAGE & SCRATCHPAD

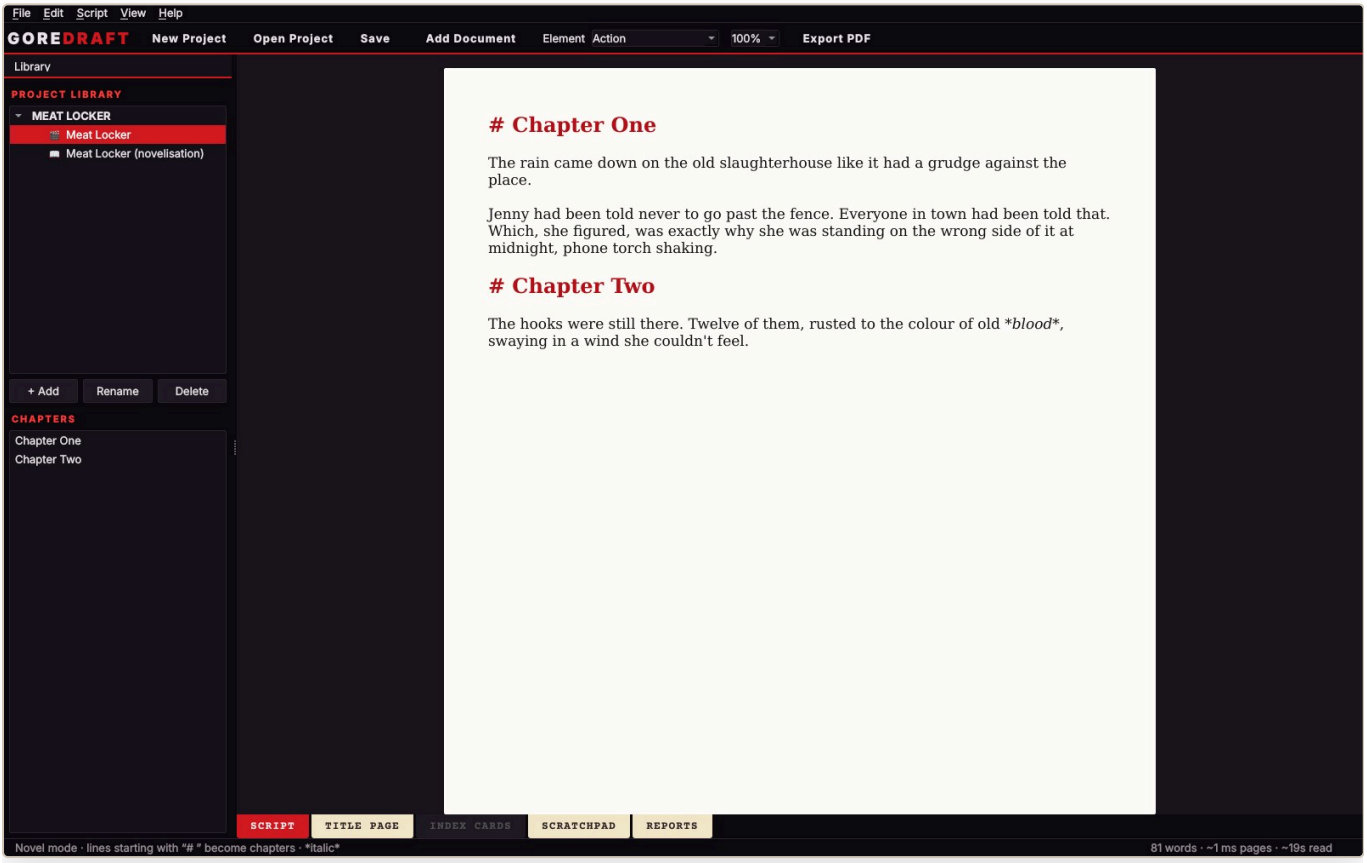
Title Page holds your title, credit, author, draft, copyright and contact details. They print on the PDF's first page.

Scratchpad is a notepad for each script: gag ideas, locations, shopping lists. It's saved with the script, and it's the yellow-paper bit you remember from the old days.



09 NOVELS

THE BOOK OF THE FILM (OR THE OTHER WAY ROUND)



Script and novelisation in one project, side by side in the library.

+ Add → Novel / prose. It's a clean page with no screenplay rules.

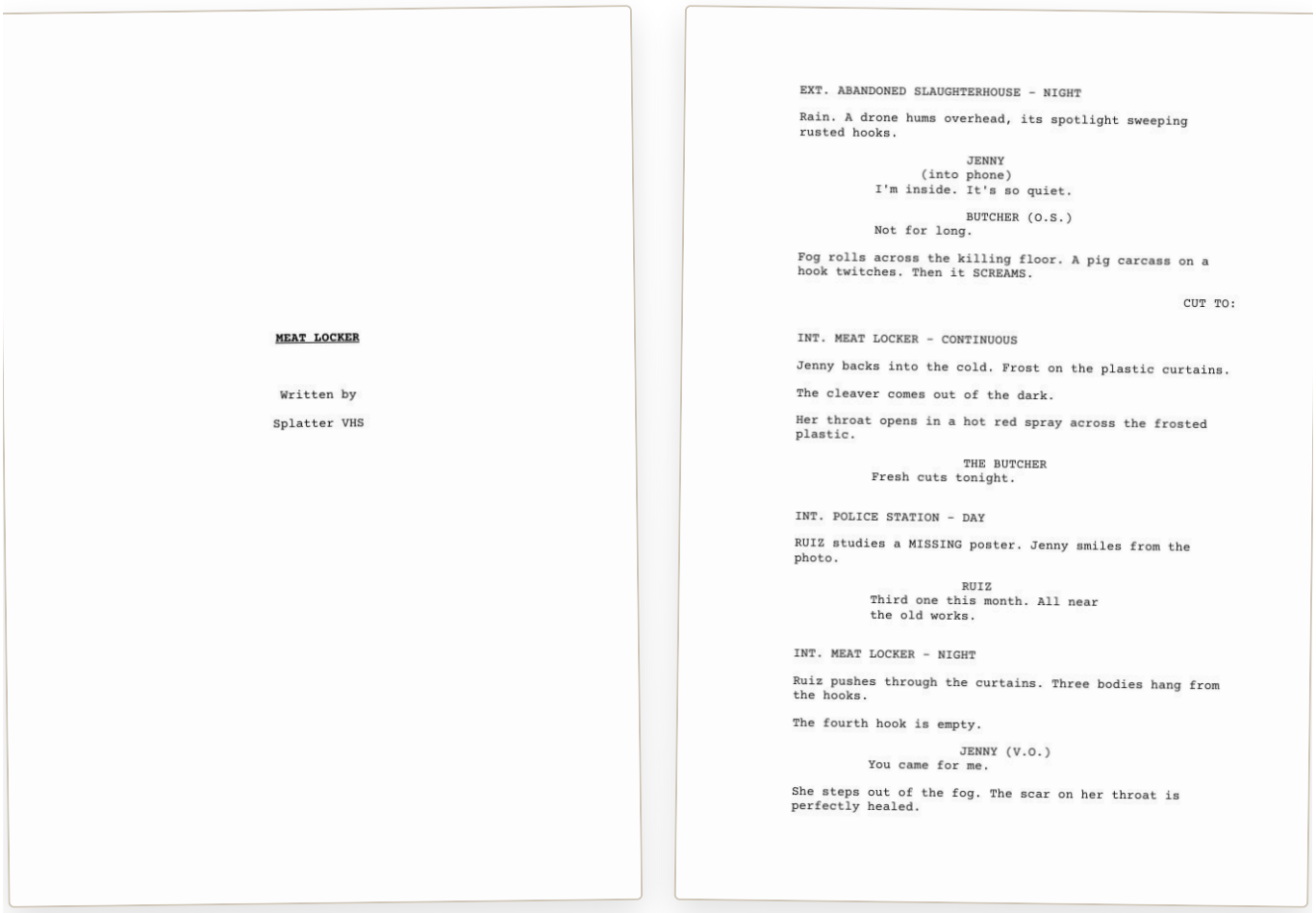
- Start a line with `#` to make a **chapter**. Chapters appear in the sidebar, and you click one to jump to it.
- Wrap words in `*stars*` for *italics*.
- The status bar shows words, manuscript pages and reading time.

Export PDF gives you a manuscript with a title page. **Export Markdown** gives you a file that opens in almost anything, including Word, Google Docs, Scrivener and Obsidian.

The **Reports** tab shows **Manuscript Stats**: words per chapter.

10 GETTING IT OUT

FOR PRODUCERS, ACTORS AND OTHER APPS



MEAT LOCKER

Written by

Splatter VHS

EXT. ABANDONED SLAUGHTERHOUSE - NIGHT

Rain. A drone hums overhead, its spotlight sweeping rusted hooks.

JENNY
(into phone)
I'm inside. It's so quiet.

BUTCHER (O.S.)
Not for long.

Fog rolls across the killing floor. A pig carcass on a hook twitches. Then it SCREAMS.

CUT TO:

INT. MEAT LOCKER - CONTINUOUS

Jenny backs into the cold. Frost on the plastic curtains.

The cleaver comes out of the dark.

Her throat opens in a hot red spray across the frosted plastic.

THE BUTCHER
Fresh cuts tonight.

INT. POLICE STATION - DAY

RUIZ studies a MISSING poster. Jenny smiles from the photo.

RUIZ
Third one this month. All near the old works.

INT. MEAT LOCKER - NIGHT

Ruiz pushes through the curtains. Three bodies hang from the hooks.

The fourth hook is empty.

JENNY (V.O.)
You came for me.

She steps out of the fog. The scar on her throat is perfectly healed.

YOU WANT	DO THIS
A script to send people	**File → Export PDF** (`Ctrl` + `P`). Choose A4 or US Letter under **File → PDF Page Size**.
To open it in Final Draft	**File → Export Final Draft (.fdx)**
To open it in Highland, Beat, WriterSolo…	**File → Export Fountain**
Novel to Word or Google Docs	**File → Export Markdown**
A report to the crew	**Reports** tab → **Export PDF…**

HEADS UP Beta honesty: PDF page breaks are close to industry standard but not identical. They don't add (MORE)/(CONT'D) when dialogue splits across pages yet. Fine for drafts; check the PDF before it goes to a producer.

11 YOUR FILES

YOURS. FOREVER. IN PLAIN TEXT.

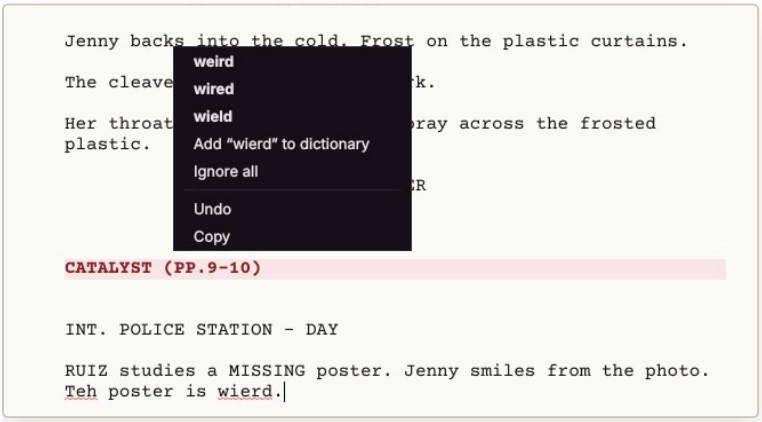
When you first **Save**, GORE DRAFT makes a folder named after your project. Inside, everything is a **normal text file**.

- **Scripts** are `.fountain` files, the open screenplay format. They open in Notepad.
- **Novels** are `.md` (Markdown) files.
- **Breakdowns** live inside the script as notes like `[[BD Blood & Gore: …]]`. Other apps ignore them, so nothing breaks.
- **Backups** are written every 3 minutes while you have unsaved changes.

To share a project, **zip the whole folder**. To back it up, copy the folder anywhere you like: USB stick, Google Drive, wherever.

```
📁 Meat Locker/
  Meat Locker.goredraft ← open this
  📁 docs/
    Meat_Locker.fountain
    Meat_Locker_novelisation.md
  📁 scratch/
    Meat_Locker.txt
  📁 backups/ ← autosaves
```

SPELLCHECK



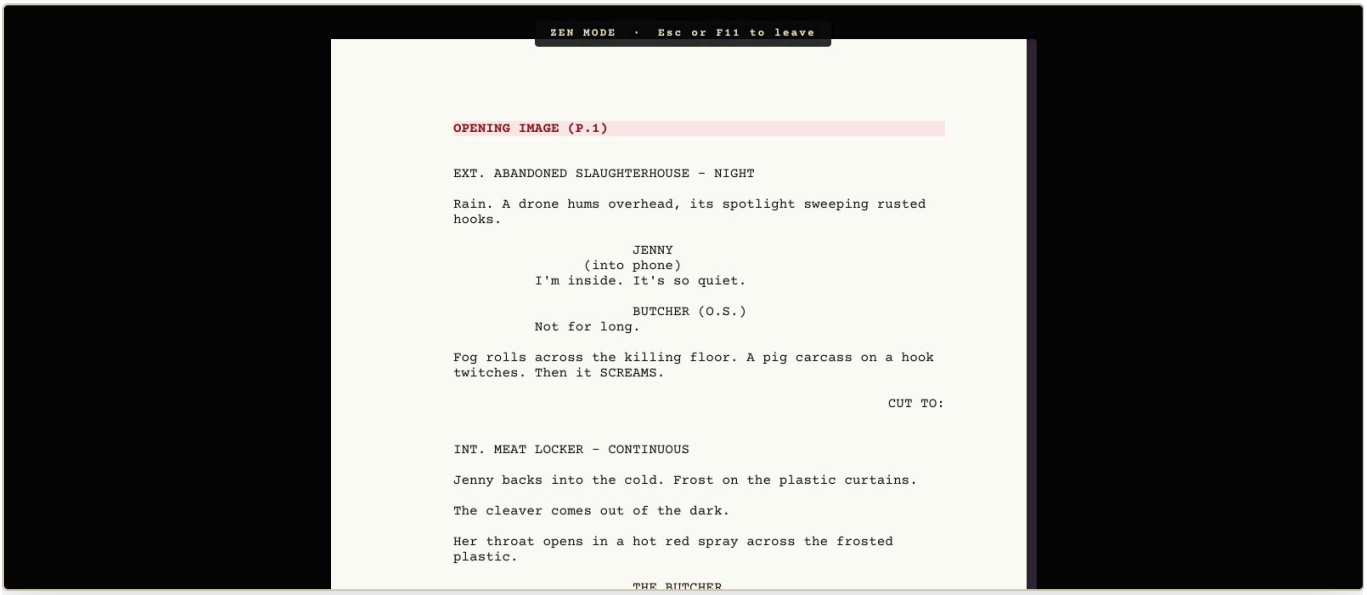
Red squiggle means a typo. **Right-click** it for suggestions, **Add to dictionary**, or **Ignore all**.

It uses Australian and British spelling, and it knows the jargon: squib, prosthetics, animatronic, hazer. It leaves your character names and ALL CAPS alone.

`F7` turns it on or off.

12 ZEN MODE

FOR BRAINS THAT WANDER OFF MID-SCENE



Press **F11**. Everything goes away except your page and the timer.

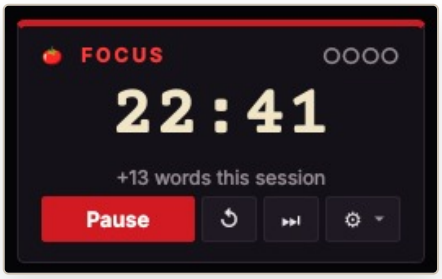
GO DARK

- `F11` or **View → Zen Mode** goes full screen, black room, just the page.
- Everything still works: `Tab`, `Enter`, spellcheck, `Ctrl`+`S`.
- `Esc` or `F11` brings the whole app back, exactly how you left it.
- Timer without full screen? **View → Focus Timer** (`Ctrl`+`Shift`+`T`).

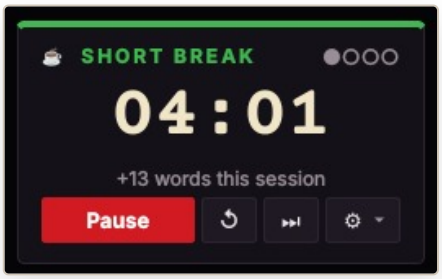
THE TOMATO TIMER

1. Hit **Start**. Write for **25 minutes**. Nothing else. No phone.
2. It beeps and flashes red. Take the **5-minute break**, then come back.
3. Every **4th** session (the ●●●● dots) you earn a **long break**.

+words this session counts what you've written since you sat down. It's proof the session counted.



Red means write.



Green means step away.

BUTTON	DOES
↺	Restart this timer
⏭	Skip to the next phase
⚙	25/5, 50/10 or 15/3 minutes

13 WHEN IT BREAKS

IT'S A BETA. IT WILL.

REPORT A PROBLEM

Help → Report a Problem opens an email to Splatter VHS with your version, your system and the error log already filled in. Just add:

1. What you were doing.
2. What you expected to happen.
3. What actually happened.

If GORE DRAFT crashes, an error box gives you the same **Report a Problem** button. Save your work first if you can.

Help → Open Log Folder shows the raw log if anyone asks for it.

Lost this manual? **Help → Read This Fucking Manual**, or just press `F1`.

KNOWN BETA LIMITS

- PDF page breaks are close to industry standard, not exact (see chapter 10).
- No revision colours or locked pages yet.
- Celtx sketches and storyboards aren't imported.
- No Mac version yet.

ABOUT AI

GORE DRAFT's code was built with Claude, an AI coding assistant. **The app itself contains no AI.** It never writes, suggests or analyses your work, it never goes online, and your scripts never leave your computer.

> **PRO TIP** The best bug report is a screenshot plus one sentence. "I dragged scene 4 onto scene 2 and scene 3 vanished" gets fixed in a day. "It's broken" doesn't.

CHEAT SHEET

PRINT THIS PAGE. TAPE IT TO THE MONITOR.

WRITING	
Enter	Next line, logical next element
Tab	Next element type / change this line
Shift + Tab	Previous element type
Ctrl + 1	Scene Heading
Ctrl + 2	Action
Ctrl + 3	Character
Ctrl + 4	Parenthetical
Ctrl + 5	Dialogue
Ctrl + 6	Transition
Ctrl + 7	Shot
Ctrl + 8	Beat marker
INT. / EXT.	Auto Scene Heading
… TO:	Auto Transition

MOVING AROUND	
Ctrl +] / [	Next / previous beat
Ctrl + Shift + ↑ ↓	Move this scene
Click a scene	Jump to it
Drag a scene / card	Reorder

FILES	
Ctrl + N	New project
Ctrl + O	Open project
Ctrl + S	Save
Ctrl + Shift + S	Save as
Ctrl + Shift + N	Add script or novel
Ctrl + P	Export PDF

BREAKDOWN	
Select → right-click	Tag as an effect, prop…
Enter in Item/Notes	Add to scene
Click a cell	Edit it
Fill in **Who**	Makes makeup continuity work

EVERYTHING ELSE	
Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Y	Undo / redo (moves too)
F11 / Esc	Zen mode on / off
Ctrl + Shift + T	Focus timer
F1	This manual
F7	Spellcheck on/off
Right-click a squiggle	Suggestions, add word
View → Minutes per Page	Tune the runtime estimate
Help → Report a Problem	Tell us what broke

NOW GO WRITE SOMETHING HORRIBLE.

GORE DRAFT is free, it's in beta, and it's made by one horror filmmaker in Brisbane who got tired of renting his own scripts back from the cloud. If it helped you get a scene on set, we want to see it.

- **Website & films:** splattervhs.com
- **Downloads & updates:** github.com/splattervhs/GoreDraft
- **Bugs & ideas:** Help → Report a Problem, inside the app

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